

edX and Udacity that have an impressive palette of courses to choose from and base their technology on cutting edge computer science innovations.

MOOCs have been successful in engaging students to pursue their interests in subjects out of their conventional syllabus. However, have they succeeded in shifting the focus from classroom learning? Hardly. The reason for this is that no matter how many advances are made in AI algorithms and how welcoming the UX of an online course is, there are a few aspects of learning that an online web-based course simply cannot address. Yes, online learning has created a positive impact on education in general, but like any gleaming new gizmo, web-based learning has its shortcomings.

For instance, in India, there's a serious shortage of quality in online learning. The IIT and IISc backed National Programme on Technology Enhanced



So much of knowledge so little time

Learning (NPTEL) programme – a Government of India initiative aimed at enhancing the quality of engineering education in the country – is well established. It has video lectures and slides for a variety of Engineering and Science subjects, but clearly lacks the structured and immersive nature of its western counterparts. While this example is country-specific, web-based learning in general has some major drawbacks.

Downsides to web-based education

Virtual interaction vs. the real deal

Classroom education delves into aspects of education that go beyond engaging the visual and auditory senses. A large component of education derives itself from interaction with peers. Granted, this is rare in most classrooms where the come-dictate-leave behaviour is prevalent, still, online social interaction is simply too detached compared to real world interaction among peer groups.

Sample this: You're solving a differential equation and pondering over which method is applicable. You post it online and scores reply. People post